INDIA TODAY
www.indiatoday.in

CHAIRMAN AND EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Aroon Purie
VICE CHAIRPERSON: Kalli Purie
GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Dinesh Bhatia

GROUP EDITORIAL DIRECTOR: Raj Chengappa

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Manoj Sharma

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR: Nilanjan Das; **GROUP PHOTO EDITOR:** Bandeep Singh
EDITOR (FEATURES): Kai Jabir Friese
MANAGING EDITORS: Sunil Menon, S. Sahaya Ranjit
EXECUTIVE EDITORS: M.G. Arun, Manisha Saroop, Kaushik Deka
SENIOR DEPUTY EDITORS: Sangram K. Parhi; HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
DEPUTY EDITORS: Sasi Nair, Anilesh S. Mahajan; JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar; MUMBAI: Suhani Singh
SENIOR EDITORS: Pradip R. Sagar, Ashish Mukherjee; PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
SENIOR ASSOCIATE EDITORS: Sonali Acharjee, Saikat Niyogi; KOLKATA: Romita Sengupta; BHOPAL: Rahul Noronha
ASSOCIATE EDITOR: Ajay Sukumaran
SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT: LUCKNOW: Prashant Srivastava
PHOTO DEPARTMENT: Rajwant Singh Rawat, Chandra Deep Kumar (Principal Photographer), MUMBAI: Mandar Suresh Deodhar (Chief Photographer)
PHOTO RESEARCHERS: Prabhakar Tiwari (Chief Photo Researcher), Saloni Vaid (Principal Photo Researcher)
CHIEF OF GRAPHICS: Tanmoy Chakraborty
ART DEPARTMENT: Sanjay Piplani (Deputy Creative Editor); Angshuman De (Art Director); Bhoomesh Dutt Sharma, Santosh Kumar Sharma (Assistant Art Directors); Siddhant Jumde (Chief Illustrator)
PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: Harish Agarwal (Chief of Production), Naveen Gupta (Chief Coordinator)

ASSOCIATE PUBLISHERS (IMPACT)
Vidya Menon,
Suparna Kumar

IMPACT TEAM
Senior General Managers: Mayur Rastogi (North), Jitendra Lad (West)
General Manager: Syed Naveed (Chennai)
GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: Vivek Malhotra

SALES AND OPERATIONS
Deepak Bhatt, Senior General Manager (National Sales)
Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations)
Rajeev Gandhi, Deputy General Manager (North)
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (West)
S Paramasivam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (South)
Piyush Ranjan Das, Senior Sales Manager (East)

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Volume 47-Number 51; For the week December 13-19, 2022, published on every Friday

• Editorial/Corporate Office Living Media India Ltd., India Today Group Mediaplex, FC-8, Sector-16A, Film City, Noida - 201301; Phone: 0120-4807100 • Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP)-201301; Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080; Mumbai: 022-66063411/3412, Kolkata: 033-40525327, Chennai: 044-24303200; e-mail: *wecare@intoday.com* • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, C-9, Sector-10, Noida-201301 (UP) • Regd. Office: F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. • Impact Offices: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One Indiabulls Centre, (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Phone: 66063355; Fax: 66063226 • E-1, Ground Floor, Videocon Towers, Jhandewalan Extn, New Delhi • Guna Complex, 5th Floor, Main Building, No.443, Anna Salai, Chennai-600018; Phone: 2847 8523 • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; • 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; • 6-3-885/7/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 ; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

Printed and published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana) and at Rajhans Enterprises, 134, Industrial Town, 4th Main Road, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560044, (Karnataka).

Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. Editor: Raj Chengappa.

• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

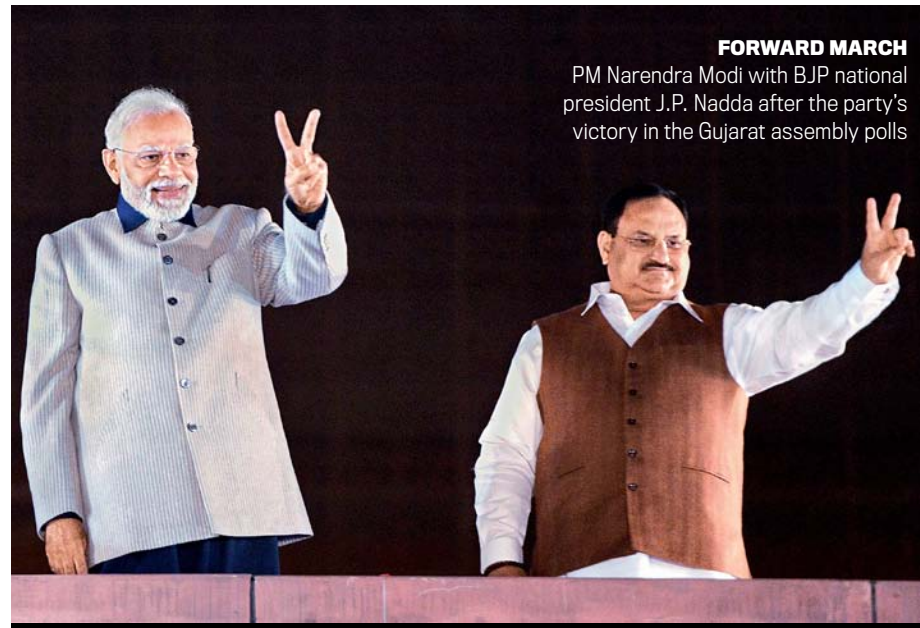
All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

SYNDICATIONS TODAY INDIA DELIVERED
For **reprint rights** and **syndication** enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

INSIDE

UPFRONT
RAJASTHAN: A FRAGILE PEACE PG 8
UP: YOGI'S BIG GAME PLAN PG 15

LEISURE
P. SAINATH: PEOPLE'S STRUGGLE PG 55
Q&A WITH PARESH MAITY PG 64



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

FORWARD MARCH
PM Narendra Modi with BJP national president J.P. Nadda after the party's victory in the Gujarat assembly polls

20
COVER STORY

THE ROAD TO 2024

The historic win in Gujarat boosts the BJP's general elections prospects despite the Himachal setback. Why it needs the Modi magic to hold

32 HOW GUJARAT WAS WON

36 CONGRESS FACE-SAVER IN HIMACHAL

Note to the reader From time to time, you will see pages titled 'An Impact Feature' or 'Focus' in INDIA TODAY. These are no different from advertisements, and the magazine's editorial staff is not involved in their creation in any way.

Cover by **NILANJAN DAS;** *Original photograph by* **PIB**

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301. Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India. Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com

E-MAIL to: **letters.editor@intoday.com** or log on to **www.indiatoday.in**